It's

a time of sandhi in Punjab—a time when things **meet and collide gently at the boundaries, intersecting, rupturing, melding and transacting with each other. In the air, the dull heat of late autumn mixes with a premonition of winter. On the flat acres below, green paddy is being cleared to make way for the seasonal carpeting of wheatish-gold. As the plough digs deeper, into the human subsoil, another kind of harvest is being born. Religion runs through India's consciousness like a gene: it orders reality, it shapes social behaviour, it moves and it anchors, as much as it estranges and cleaves. Here, even when framed within Punjab's melting-pot history, something novel and mould-breaking is emerging. A wave of Charismatic Christianity—drawing from the worldwide Pentecostal movement—is sweeping through Punjab in tidal volumes and generating all sorts of conflicting emotions. A deep sense of belonging and ecstatic hope for those on the inside, disquiet for those watching from the ringside. It's a new borderland. One that Punjab, with all its scars from previous border-making, is not used to and does not know how to orient itself to.**

Things look normal enough on the surface till you wind past the featureless cityscape of Jalandhar to Khambra village, on its periurban edges. Going to the Ankur Narula Ministry on a Sunday is like visiting Delhi's Akshardham complex; at 65 acres, it's even bigger in physical area. Its spiritual catchment area matches that in scale. Just 37, and born to a Hindu Khatri family that traded in marble in Jalandhar, Narula has that clean-cut, cherubic look that could blend into middle manage-



